
WHISTLE-BLOWER POLICY [Vigil Mechanism]

*[Policy approved and adopted by the Board of Directors on **September 05, 2026**,
effective from **September 05, 2026**]*

TABLE OF CONTENTS

S. No.	Particulars	Page No.
1	Introduction	3
2	Purpose/Objective of the Policy	3
3	Scope/ Applicability	3-4
4	Definitions	4-5
5	Matters covered and Reporting Principles	5
6	Process of lodging complaint / Protected Disclosure	5-6
7	Disqualifications	6
8	Preliminary Assessment	6-7
9	Investigation	7
10	Complaints against Directors / KMP / Senior Management	7
11	Decision and Reporting	7-8
12	Protection	8
13	Confidentiality	8
14	Direct Access to the Board	9
15	Retention of Documents	9
16	Confirmation	9
17	Review and Amendments	9
18	Disclosures	9
19	Version Control / Approval History	10

1. INTRODUCTION

The Board of Directors (“Board”) of **NDR Smart Spaces Private Limited** (formerly *NDR Smart Warehouses Private Limited*) (“Company” or “NDR Smart”) recognises the importance of maintaining high standards of integrity, transparency, accountability and ethical conduct in the affairs of the Company.

As part of its internal control framework and good corporate governance practices, the Company has voluntarily adopted this **Vigil Mechanism/Whistle-Blower Policy** (“Policy”) on September 05, 2026 (effective from September 05, 2026), to provide a structured and secure mechanism for Directors, employees and other eligible persons to raise genuine concerns regarding unethical behaviour, fraud, misconduct, violation of applicable laws or Company policies, or other improper activities.

The Policy shall provide for adequate safeguards against victimization or retaliation against persons who make a Protected Disclosure in good faith.

2. PURPOSE / OBJECTIVE OF THE POLICY

The Company believes in conducting its affairs in a fair and transparent manner by adopting the highest standards of professionalism, honesty, integrity and ethical behavior.

The purpose of this Policy is to:

1. provide a secure and confidential mechanism for reporting genuine concerns relating to unethical behaviour, fraud, misconduct or other improper activities;
2. encourage Directors, employees and other eligible persons to raise concerns at an early stage so that appropriate action may be considered;
3. enable the Company to appropriately assess and, where warranted, investigate concerns raised under this Policy;
4. provide appropriate safeguards against victimisation or retaliation against a person who makes a Protected Disclosure in good faith;
5. ensure that concerns raised are dealt with in a fair, objective and consistent manner; and
6. strengthen the Company’s internal control framework and promote a culture of ethical conduct, accountability and transparency.

This Policy is intended to cover serious concerns which may have a material or adverse impact on the operations, financial position, reputation, governance or interests of the Company.

3. SCOPE/APPLICABILITY:

This Policy applies to all the Directors and employees of the Company. This Policy neither release employees from their duty of confidentiality in the course of their work nor can it be used as a route for raising malicious or unfounded allegations against people in authority and/or colleagues in general.

This Policy covers malpractices and events which have taken place/suspected to have taken place, misuse or abuse of authority, fraud or suspected fraud, violation of company rules, manipulations, negligence causing danger to public health and safety, misappropriation of monies and other matters or activity on account of which the interest of the Company is affected and formally reported by whistle blowers concerning its employees.

The mechanism under this Policy is intended primarily for reporting serious concerns relating to matters covered under this Policy. Routine employment-related matters, personal grievances or complaints which are appropriately dealt with under other policies or procedures of the Company should ordinarily be raised through the relevant channel, unless such matter involves conduct covered under this Policy.

4. DEFINITIONS:

“Board” means board of directors of the Company, as constituted from time to time.

“Company” shall mean **NDR Smart Spaces Private Limited**.

“Directors” means Directors of the Company.

“Employee” means all the present employees and whole-time Directors of the Company (whether working in India or abroad).

“Independent Director” means a Director referred to in Section 149(6) of the Act read with rules made thereunder, as amended from time to time.

“Policy” shall mean the whistle-blower policy / vigil mechanism.

“Protected Disclosure” means any communication made in good faith to disclose information relating to actual or suspected unethical or improper activity/ behavior. It should be factual and based on reasonable grounds and should not be speculative in nature.

“Unethical Behavior” means and includes any suspected or alleged illegal, false, misleading, dishonest, deceptive, unethical or unconscionable conduct, including bribery and corruption, retaliation or victimisation, falsification of books or records, misuse of confidential information or other conduct that is contrary to applicable law, the Company's policies or ethical standards.

The unethical, improper and illegal activities *inter-alia* include–

1. An act of omission, commission, concealment, misrepresentation which necessarily are in violation of law of the land, rules and regulation of the Company, Memorandum and Articles of Association of the Company and against the accepted principles jeopardizing the interest and growth of the Company.
2. Misuse or diversion of the Company's funds, property and manpower.
3. Intentional financial irregularities, including fraud or suspected frauds
4. Unnecessary sharing/ Leaking of unpublished price sensitive information.
5. Manipulation of Company data/records.
6. Gross or willful negligence causing substantial and specific danger to health, safety and environment.
7. Any act, deed or thing which goes against the interest of the Company.

“Vigilance Officer” means a person nominated/appointed by the board of directors to receive Protected Disclosure from Whistle-Blowers, maintaining records thereof, coordinate the preliminary assessment / investigation of matters raised under this Policy and place the matter before the appropriate authority for consideration and necessary action.

“Whistle-Blower” or “Complainant” means an employee or a director or any other stakeholders such as borrowers, co-borrowers, consultants, business partners, direct selling agents, vendors or any other person having a business relationship with the Company, who makes a protected disclosure under this policy. He/ She is neither an investigator nor a finder of facts, nor does he/ she determine the appropriate corrective or remedial action that may be warranted.

5. MATTERS COVERED AND REPORTING PRINCIPLES:

A Whistle-Blower may make a Protected Disclosure where he/she has reasonable grounds to believe that any actual, suspected or potential instance of Unethical Behaviour, fraud, misconduct, violation of applicable law, violation of Company policies or other improper activity has occurred, is occurring or is likely to occur.

A Protected Disclosure should be made in good faith and should, to the extent reasonably possible, contain sufficient information to enable the Company to understand the nature of the concern and undertake an appropriate preliminary assessment.

The Whistle-Blower should, where available, provide relevant facts and information, including:

1. a description of the concern or alleged misconduct;
2. the names or details of persons involved, if known;
3. relevant dates, locations and circumstances, if known;
4. supporting documents, records or other evidence, if available; and
5. any other information which may assist in assessing or investigating the concern.

The Whistle-Blower is not required to establish or prove the allegations. However, the Whistle-Blower should not knowingly make false, malicious, frivolous or unfounded allegations.

The Company shall determine, based on the nature and circumstances of the Protected Disclosure, whether the matter requires preliminary assessment, further investigation or any other appropriate action.

6. PROCESS FOR LODGING COMPLAINT / PROTECTED DISCLOSURE:

1. The protected disclosure shall be made in writing.
2. The Protected Disclosure may be submitted in a closed or secured envelope, or through email or such other secure channels as may be notified by the Company from time to time.
3. The protected disclosures that express anonymously will not be investigated.
4. The Complainant shall mention his/her name and address at the beginning or at the end of the letter or in an attached letter.
5. The envelope should be super scribed with “Complaint under Whistle Blower Mechanism”.
6. The complaint shall be drafted carefully and should contain sufficient details to enable the Company to understand and assess the concern raised. The identity and contact details of the Complainant should be clearly provided.
7. All Protected Disclosures should be addressed to the Vigilance Officer of the Company.
8. Where the Protected Disclosure relates to the Vigilance Officer, or where the Whistle-Blower considers it inappropriate to report the matter to the Vigilance Officer, the Protected Disclosure may be made directly to the Board or such Director as may be designated by the Board for this purpose.

The contact details of the **Vigilance Officer** are as under: -

Ms. Lavanya Prabhakar

Head - Human Resource

NDR Group Office, 2nd Floor,

No. 56/1, Next to GT Reddy Cars, Bazullah Road,

T. Nagar, Thygarayanagar, Chennai – 600017,

Tamil Nadu, India.

Email: hrm@ndram.com

The Vigilance Officer shall be responsible for receiving Protected Disclosures, maintaining appropriate records, coordinating preliminary review/investigation and placing matters before the appropriate authority for consideration and necessary action.

An acknowledgement of receipt may be provided to the Whistle-Blower, subject to maintaining confidentiality. The Vigilance Officer may seek additional information or clarification where considered necessary.

Anonymous / Pseudonymous disclosure shall not be entertained by the Vigilance Officer. On receipt of the Protected Disclosure, the Vigilance Officer shall where the identity of the Whistle-Blower is provided in a separate covering letter, detach the covering letter bearing the identity of the Whistle-Blower and process the Protected Disclosure while maintaining the confidentiality of the Whistle-Blower's identity.

The Vigilance Officer shall maintain a register of the Protected Disclosures received from the Whistle Blowers, with each Disclosure serially numbered and the action taken/recorded in each case.

7. DISQUALIFICATIONS:

While it will be ensured that genuine Whistle-Blowers are accorded complete protection from any kind of unfair treatment as herein set out, any abuse of this protection will warrant disciplinary action.

Protection under this Policy would not mean protection from disciplinary action arising out of false or bogus allegations made by a Whistle-Blower knowing it to be false or bogus or with a mala fide intention.

Whistle-Blowers, who make any Protected Disclosures, which have been subsequently found to be mala fide, frivolous or malicious, may be subject to appropriate disciplinary or other action in accordance with the applicable rules, procedures and policies of the Company.

8. PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

The Vigilance Officer should conduct a preliminary assessment to determine:

1. whether the matter falls within the scope of this Policy;
2. whether sufficient information exists to proceed further;
3. whether immediate action is required;
4. whether there is any actual or potential conflict of interest; and
5. whether the matter should be referred directly to the Board or such other appropriate authority.

Based on the preliminary assessment, the Vigilance Officer may recommend that the matter be closed, require further information or clarification, or proceed with an investigation, as considered appropriate.

9. INVESTIGATION:

All Protected Disclosures under this policy will be appropriately recorded and assessed. Where considered necessary based on the preliminary assessment, the matter shall be investigated.

The Vigilance Officer may carry out the investigation himself/herself or involve any other officer of the Company, a committee constituted for the purpose, or an external agency, as considered appropriate, before placing the matter before the Board or such other appropriate authority.

The Board or the appropriate authority, as the case may be, may call for further information or particulars from the person against whom the Protected Disclosure has been made (“**Subject**”) and may, at its discretion, consider involving any other officer of the Company, committee or external agency for the purpose of investigation.

The Subject shall have a duty to co-operate with the investigator and shall not interfere with or obstruct the investigation process.

The Vigilance Officer / investigator may seek further information or documentary evidence from the Whistle-Blower in support of the Protected Disclosure, where considered necessary.

The investigation by itself shall not tantamount to an accusation and shall be treated as a neutral fact-finding process.

The investigation shall normally be completed within 90 days of receipt of the Protected Disclosure and may be extended by such further period as may be considered reasonable, depending upon the nature, complexity and circumstances of the matter.

Any person, including the Vigilance Officer, investigator, external consultant or other officer, who has any actual or potential conflict of interest in relation to the matter shall disclose such conflict forthwith and shall not deal with or participate in the matter.

10. COMPLAINTS AGAINST DIRECTORS / KMP / SENIOR MANAGEMENT

Where a Protected Disclosure concerns a Director, Key Managerial Personnel, senior personnel, the Vigilance Officer or any person who may have an actual or potential conflict of interest in the matter, the complaint shall be referred directly to the Board or such other Director as may be designated by the Board for this purpose.

11. DECISION AND REPORTING:

If an investigation leads to a conclusion that an improper or unethical act has been committed, the Vigilance Officer shall place the investigation report, together with the relevant evidences and documents, before the Board or such other appropriate authority, as applicable, for consideration and necessary action.

The Board or the appropriate authority, as applicable, may recommend or take appropriate corrective, remedial, disciplinary or other action, as may be warranted, based on the findings of the investigation.

The action taken on the report may, subject to applicable law and confidentiality requirements, be communicated to the Whistle-Blower and/or the Subject, as considered appropriate.

A Whistle-Blower who makes false allegations of unethical & improper practices or about alleged wrongful conduct of the Subject, knowing the same to be false or with a mala fide intention, may be subject to appropriate disciplinary action in accordance with the rules, procedures and policies of the Company.

While acting under this Policy, employees shall act with utmost *bona fide* intention. Any report or complaint made under this Policy should be made in good faith and should, to the extent reasonably possible, be based on factual information and supporting evidence, where available. The safeguarding of the interests of the Company shall be guiding consideration.

Quarterly Reporting: A quarterly report containing the number of Protected Disclosures received, number investigated, number closed, number pending, nature/category of complaints and action taken under this Policy shall be placed before the Board or such other appropriate authority, as may be considered appropriate.

12. PROTECTION:

The Company shall not threaten, discriminate against or take retaliatory action against any person in a manner which adversely affects such person's employment or engagement with the Company merely because such person has made a Protected Disclosure in good faith or has participated or provided information in an investigation, hearing or enquiry initiated under this Policy.

No unfair treatment will be meted out to a Whistle Blower by virtue of his/ her having reported a Protected Disclosure under this policy. The Company shall provide appropriate safeguards against victimization of complainants. The Company will take steps to minimize difficulties, which the Whistle Blower may experience as a result of making the Protected Disclosure.

This, however, does not preclude a superior or management from taking appropriate action against an employee for misconduct, indiscipline, poor job performance or retrenchment as per the policy of the Company, provided such action is not retaliatory in nature.

The identity of the Whistle Blower shall be kept confidential to the extent possible and permitted under applicable law. Any other employee or person assisting in the said investigation shall also be protected to the same extent as the Whistle Blower.

13. CONFIDENTIALITY:

The complainant, Vigilance Officer, the subject and every person involved in the process shall, maintain confidentiality of all matters under this Policy, discuss only to the extent or with those people as required under this policy for completing the process of investigations and keep the papers in safe custody. The identity of the Whistle-Blower shall be kept confidential to the extent reasonably practicable and permitted by applicable law.

14. DIRECT ACCESS TO THE BOARD:

The Whistle-Blower shall have the right to make a Protected Disclosure directly to the Board of Directors in appropriate or exceptional cases, including where the Protected Disclosure concerns the Vigilance Officer or where the Whistle-Blower considers it inappropriate to report the matter to the Vigilance Officer.

The Board may designate any Director or other appropriate person to receive, assess or investigate such Protected Disclosure and may prescribe suitable directions for dealing with the matter, as considered appropriate.

Where the Protected Disclosure concerns a particular Director, such Director shall not participate in the consideration, assessment or investigation of such matter.

15. RETENTION OF DOCUMENTS:

All Protected Disclosures in writing or documented along with the results of Investigation relating thereto, shall be retained by the Company for a minimum period of three years or such longer period as may be required under applicable law, litigation hold, investigation requirements or Company policy.

16. CONFIRMATION:

The Company shall periodically review the functioning of the Vigil Mechanism and the concerns reported under this Policy as part of its internal control and governance framework. The aforesaid disclosure shall also be incorporated in the Board's Report in the Annual Report of the Company.

17. REVIEW AND AMENDMENTS:

This Policy shall be reviewed by the Board, from time to time, as considered necessary, in accordance with the statutory and business requirements of the Company. The Company reserves the right to alter, modify, add, delete or amend any of the provisions of this Policy. Any amendment to this Policy shall be approved by the Board of Directors.

18. DISCLOSURES:

- ✓ This Policy shall be communicated to the HR Head of the Company for internal circulation.
- ✓ This Policy shall be made available to the Directors and employees of the Company through the Company's internal communication channels and shall be hosted on the Company's website, once operational, as applicable. The weblink to the Policy shall also be provided in the Annual Report, wherever applicable.
- ✓ The Policy may also be made available to other persons covered under the Policy through such channels as may be considered appropriate by the Company.

Version Control / Approval History

Version	Effective Date	Approved By	Board Resolution Date	Amendment / Revision Details
1	September 05, 2026	Board of Directors	September 05, 2026	Initial adoption of the Whistle Blower Policy